

god? Are you out there?

Maybe god is merciful.
Maybe god is a gardener and
you are a rose in bloom.
Even though they are gentle and precise with their shears,
you still tremble with grief
as your leaves are lost to the void below.
Because you are a rose,
you cannot see the shape of the hedge.

Maybe god is neutral at best.
Maybe god is the front half of a horse costume and
you are the schmuck hunched over in the back.
As you look forward and see nothing but ass,
you have to trust
that this rando from Craigslist can guide you
among the muddy shapes that emerge through cross-hatched horse eye mesh,
and that their lunch has already digested.

Maybe god is not a miracle-worker.
Maybe god is an amateur magician and
you are a wine glass that got too comfortable on the tablecloth.
They yank the linen out from under you less smoothly than you'd like.
The plates rattle,
the utensils clatter,
and you fall over,
your red seeping into white.

Maybe god is fallible.
Maybe god is your lover in the kitchen at three a.m.
after a long day—
no, week—
no, month—
sitting on the countertop and
you are standing two feet away from them.
Both of you are close enough to reach out
but both of you choose not to.

It wouldn't have mattered, anyway,
if they leaned over and squeezed you with their left hand
because in the palm of their right already sits your heart.
It is pulsing
and it is juicy
and it is bleeding
like a cut pomegranate.

Maybe Octavia Butler was right in the end.
Maybe god is change, and god
doesn't give a fuck
about who you are,
or if you pray,
or how much you hope—
not as long as the universe keeps barreling forward without rhyme
or reason.

I wouldn't know.
I'm not god—
though maybe once I was someone's
concept of a heaven.
The bible says not to worship false idols, anyway.

Maybe that's why we ended.
Maybe god punished me.
I always thought you might be an angel.
Little did I know, I let you become God.